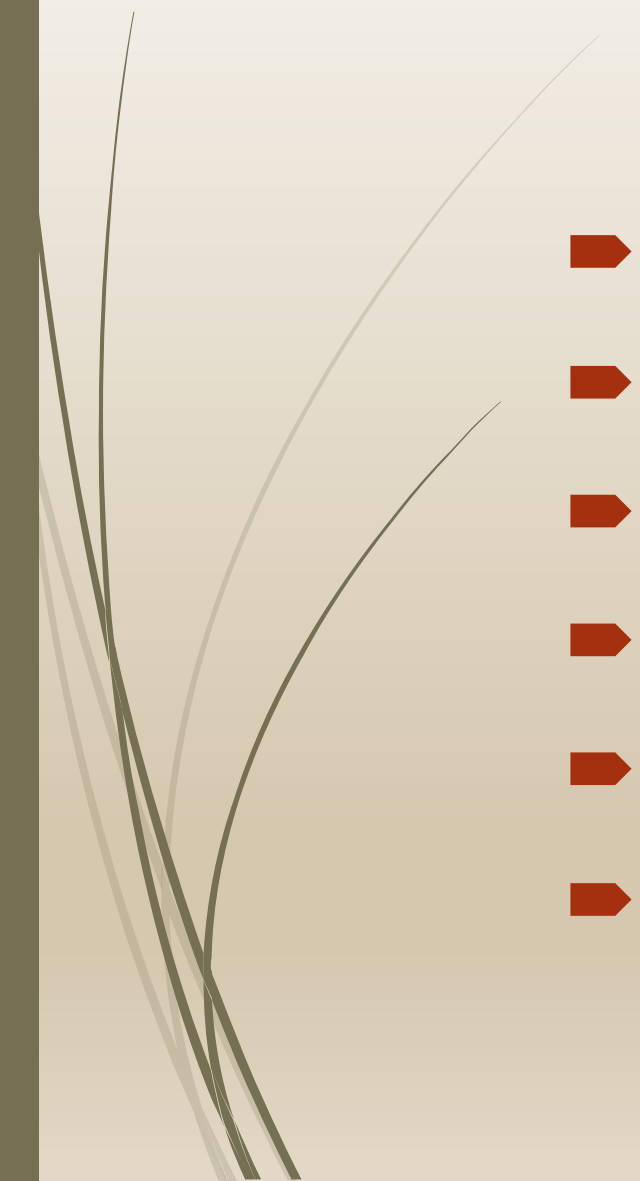


Selecting and integrating sources

Source types, selection,
academic integrity
and referencing



Topics covered

- Academic source **types** and uses
 - Source **assessment**
 - **Plagiarism** and academic dishonesty
 - Source **integration**
 - Source **attribution** structures
 - **Reporting verbs**
- 

Three categories of academic sources

PRIMARY

- "raw" or uninterpreted data; vary by discipline

SECONDARY

- articles that interpret primary data to make an argument or propose a solution to a problem

TERTIARY

- Textbooks, manuals, guides and articles in popular publications that summarize or explain secondary sources



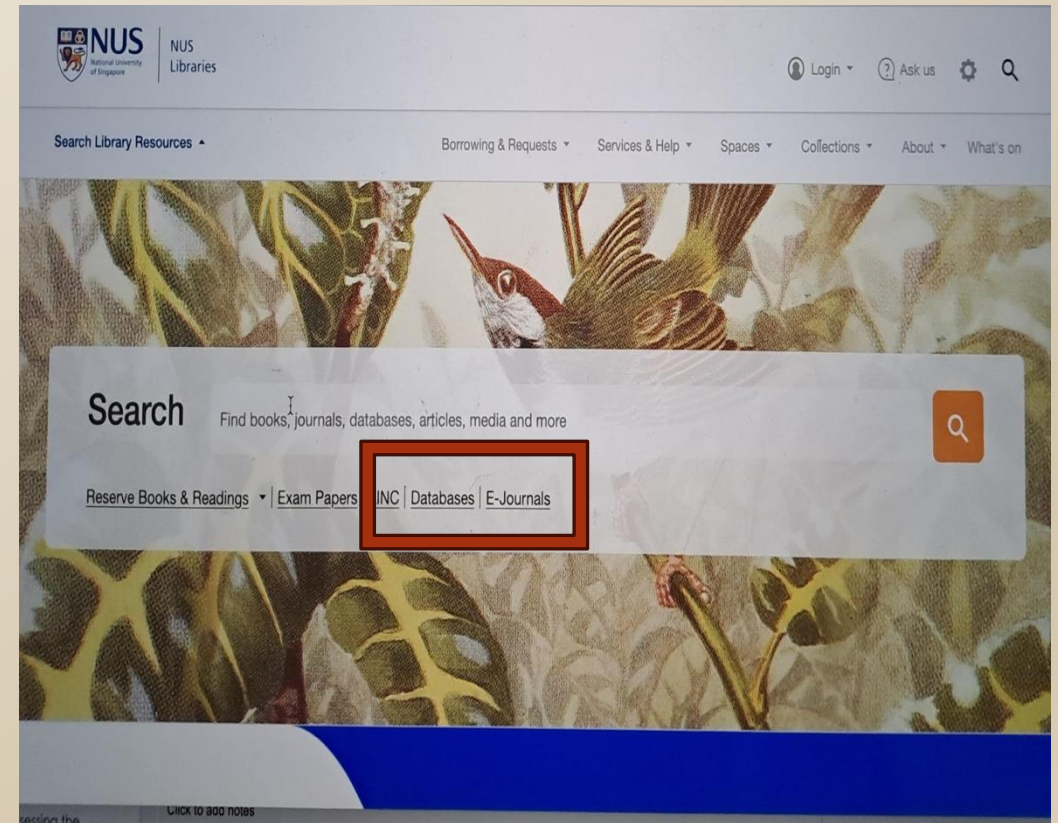
Uses of secondary sources

In general, academic secondary sources help researchers

- (a) determine what has already been written on the subject to identify gaps, tensions, contexts and problems worth examining
- (b) derive concepts, models or frameworks that can be used to analyze the problem and/or primary data
- (c) derive or develop an appropriate research methodology for analysis
- (d) support, extend, problematize or contest claims or perspectives on the topic.

Finding and assessing the reliability of secondary sources

- **NUS Libraries:** books, academic databases and online journals
- Searching within NUS libraries and academic databases:
- Finding articles and books:
https://libguides.nus.edu.sg/find_library_resources
- Google Scholar:
<https://libguides.nus.edu.sg/findfulltext>
- **For your assignments, you may use a combination of *scholarly* and *popular* sources like news articles from reputable media publications.**





Evaluating source credibility



Authority

Relevance

Currency

Accuracy

Purpose



In summary, ask:

Should you use this source? If so, how will it support your project?

Will your audience find this source credible and persuasive? Why?

Is the credibility of this source suspect in any way? How?



Plagiarism and academic dishonesty

- What is it? Why is it considered a serious offence?

<https://libguides.nus.edu.sg/new2nus/acadintegrity>

- NUS code of conduct for students (Section A):

<https://studentconduct.nus.edu.sg/wp-content/uploads/NUS-Code-of-Student-Conduct.pdf>



Academic integrity: Understanding and avoiding plagiarism

- Go through the **NUS policy on plagiarism**:
<https://myportal.nus.edu.sg/studentportal/student-discipline/all/docs/NUS-Plagiarism-Policy.pdf>
- Read the relevant extracts from the **NUS interim policy on AI use** (see handout accompanying this lecture or 'syllabus and assessments' document) and **include a declaration** for each assignment
- Cite *all* your sources properly
- Check with your instructor if you have questions



Referencing: APA style

- In-text citations (in parentheses)
- A reference list or bibliography

You may use software to create your reference list. But please check that the information is complete and correctly formatted.

Detailed guidelines on APA style (7th edition) may be found here. Click on the vertical tabs on the left of the page for formatting information with examples:
https://owl.purdue.edu/owl/research_and_citation/apa_style/apa_formatting_and_style_guide/general_format.html

APA basics, NUS Libraries:

https://libguides.nus.edu.sg/ld.php?content_id=49148778



Integrating sources into your writing

- Sources must *support* your argument, not make it for you. To maintain your authorial voice, it is important to use sources “strategically” and “purposefully” (Alfano & O’Brien, 2008, p. 190).
- We typically integrate sources into our writing in three ways:
 1. **Summary:** to synthesize and condense ideas from one or more sources
 2. **Paraphrase:** to rephrase a quotation in your own words (but with the same level of detail as the original)
 3. **Direct quotation:** providing an excerpt from the source in quotation marks

Sources must be properly acknowledged in all three cases.



Quoting from sources

(adapted from Alfano & O'Brien, 2008)

Keep direct quotations to a minimum in your papers. Quoting the occasional term, concept or phrase may be impactful but avoid quoting entire sentences. As far as possible, paraphrase.

1. Use a **lead-in** clause/phrase to introduce the quote. **Incorporate** the quote into your sentence.

Example: In their recent article on Open AI's ChatGPT, Chomsky et al (2023) argue that such language learning models "differ profoundly from how humans reason and use language."

This is an online source without page numbers.

2. If the original quote is long, consider breaking it up using an **interrupted structure**.

Example: "By emphasizing the basic moral identity and equality of human beings and animals," Calarco argues that the identity-based approach "calls for a fundamental rethinking of a whole host of human activities that impact animals in negative and harmful ways" (Calarco, 2011, p. 43).

3. After inserting the quotation, provide a **closing comment or explanation** that either emphasizes the relevance of the quotation or helps advance the argument in some way.

Example: By dismissing the film as "propaganda," Smith (2010) fails to consider its use of evidence from different sources to convey its point about the impacts of climate change.



Attribution structures

Integral	Non-integral
The cited author is named in the sentence.	The author is referenced in parentheses (if using APA) or using superscript numbers.
<u>Examples</u> In her discussion of recent advances in machine learning, Archer (2022) explains how ... Chomsky et al (2022) argue that ...	<u>Examples</u> (a) The contemporary university has a close relationship with both state and society and as such, has a duty to engage in socially responsible activities (Barnett 2012b; Kimura-Walsh 2010; Manathunga et al. 2012). (b) Despite differing terms, at the heart of all these varieties is the desire to provoke students to go beyond the world they know and feel comfortable in, to expand their understanding of a range of social possibilities and achieve a more equal and just future (Freire 1996; Giroux 2011).



Attribution structures contd.

(you may use both in your writing)

Integral	Non-integral
To emphasize the author or agent; useful for foregrounding your authorial voice when engaging with scholarship.	To emphasize the reported message or process over the author/writer.

Reporting Verbs (adapted from Hyland, 1999; Hyland & Jiang, 2019)

For more examples of reporting verbs, you may also refer to this handout:

<https://www.ncl.ac.uk/mediav8/academic-skills-kit/file-downloads/Reporting%20verbs.pdf>

Verbs to convey **Research Acts**
(findings and procedures)

Findings – *observe, discover, notice, show*
Procedures – *analyze, calculate, measure, assay, explore*

Verbs to convey **Cognition Acts**
related to mental processes

believe, conceptualize, suspect, view

Verbs to convey **Discourse Acts**
related to verbal expression

ascribe, discuss, hypothesize, explain, state, remark, mention, articulate, convey

Evaluative verbs that attribute a position to the author being cited and sometimes communicating the writer's stance or judgment on the cited source

Reporting the information cited as true:
acknowledge, point out, establish
negative: *fail, overlook, exaggerate, ignore*
positive: *advocate, argue, hold, see*
neutral: *address, cite, comment, examine*
tentative: *allude to, hypothesize, believe, suggest*
critical: *attack, condemn, object, refute*

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